

Slides 6.6: Cooking Methods, Dry Heat, Moist Heat, and Why

Slide outline for Lesson 6.6. Thirteen slides, one day. Slides 4 and 5 are the review deck for the Cooking Methods Check. *[Sal: take a photo of the two plated potatoes at the end of the period. That photo is a better review slide than anything stock.]*

Slide 1: Dry Heat, Moist Heat, and Why

- Unit 6, Lesson 6.6
- Topic 6.2 Food Preparation Methods and Science
- Today: the same potato, two ways Image: a baked potato split open beside a boiled potato, both on the same plate.

Slide 2: Do now

- List every way you can think of to cook a potato
- One word each
- Go for six Notes: Build one list on the board from four students. Circle the ones that use water and underline the ones that do not, and do not say why yet.

Slide 3: Both of these are already going

- Same potato
- Same pound, same field, same day
- In thirty minutes one is brown and crisp and one is pale and soft
- Nothing changed but the water Image: an oven with a potato on a sheet pan, and a pot of water on a burner. Notes: This is the hook. Point at the real oven and the real pot.

Slide 4: DRY HEAT: no water touching the food

- **Bake:** hot dry air in an oven, for batters and doughs
- **Roast:** the same air, hotter, for meat and vegetables
- **Broil:** heat from above only, very close, very hot
- **Toast:** dry heat on the surface until brown
- **Sauté:** a little fat in a hot pan, food kept moving, done fast Image: five small photos, one per method. Notes: Sauté is the one students get wrong. Fat is not water, and fat gets hotter than water can. That is why things brown in it.

Slide 5: MOIST HEAT: water or steam surrounds the food

- **Boil:** fully covered, rolling, 212 degrees
- **Simmer:** lower heat, small bubbles at the edge, long cooking
- **Steam:** above the water, never touching it
- **Poach:** barely moving liquid, for delicate foods Image: four small photos, one per method.

Slide 6: The one sentence

- Dry heat drives water off the surface, so the surface can brown
- Moist heat surrounds the food with water or steam, so the surface stays wet and cannot brown Notes: Say it twice. This sentence is item 6 on the Cooking Methods Check.

Slide 7: We do not fry in this room

- Frying needs oil at 350 degrees or hotter
- A pot of hot oil is the one hazard this course does not take on
- Oil fires cannot be put out with water
- An oven or a broiler gets close to what a fryer does Notes: Say the reason, not just the rule. Students accept a rule with a reason and argue with a rule without one.

Slide 8: Browning, in plain words

- The surface gets hot and dry
- The sugars and proteins in it change into new compounds
- Those compounds are brown, and they smell and taste stronger
- Nothing browns until the surface water is gone Image: four stages of a piece of toast, pale to golden to brown. Notes: Toast versus bread is the fastest example in the world. Use it.

Slide 9: Match eight foods to a method

- A chicken breast, a potato you want crisp, broccoli, rice
- An egg, a slice of bread, apple slices, a pound of dry pasta
- One method each, and a reason that says what the heat does
- Two of these have more than one right answer Notes: Groups of four with the method cards. Twelve minutes. Let them argue about the egg and the apple; both are intentionally open.

Slide 10: The question at your table

- Point at a card in the dry pile
- What is the water doing in that one? Notes: A “got it” answer says there is no water, or the water leaves. A group that puts steaming in the dry pile because no liquid touches the food gets a follow-up question, not an answer. That is a good mistake.

Slide 11: The demonstration record

- Color
- Texture
- Smell
- Taste, only if you choose to Notes: Plate both versions. Run the four rows out loud in order. Own fork, own plate, nobody reaches into a shared pan. Nobody has to taste anything and no reason is required.

Slide 12: The compare sentence

- You must use the words **browning** and **moisture**
- "The baked one is ___ because ___" Notes: Take three answers that use both words. Write the strongest one on the board and leave it up.

Slide 13: Exit card

- Dry heat is for ___
- Moist heat is for ___
- The food I would cook tomorrow is ___ by ___ Notes: Sort into "got it" and "needs more." Tell students which methods they will personally run in Lessons 6.8 and 6.9; that buys you a quiet last five minutes.